

What's New In Surveillance and Security

One of the big trends in electronic surveillance is the convergence of two historically distinct security functions—physical security and information security—within enterprises. Integrated security systems allow facility managers to efficiently and intelligently handle any event or incident, addressing the risks of safety, security and operations at the same time and place



Mobile surveillance over 3G

DR S.S. VERMA

Surveillance and security, much like other fields, has caught the technology bug. The market is adopting concepts like convergence and interoperability. Everything from access control systems to fire safety panels is integrating more and more complex electronic features and capabilities.

On the adoption front, electronic

surveillance is all pervasive. In the developed world, the state, the judiciary and the military use surveillance technology. Business rivals, departmental stores, shopping malls, apartments, parking lots, hospitals, banks, employers and even family members employ different methods of electronic eavesdropping. Law enforcement agencies use surveillance to gather evidence of a crime or to accumulate intelligence

about suspected criminal activity. Business competitors use electronic surveillance to secure their premises or to gather information about rivals.

Types of electronic surveillance

According to The Free Dictionary, electronic surveillance is legally defined as observing or listening to persons, places or activities, usually in a secretive or unobtrusive manner, with the aid of electronic devices such as cameras, microphones, tape recorders or wire taps. Surveillance is done by governments, law enforcement agencies, individuals and corporates alike.

As per *Wikipedia*, surveillance is done to maintain social control, recognise and monitor threats, and prevent/investigate criminal activity.

Wikipedia enlists the types of surveillance as computer surveillance, telephonic surveillance, camera surveillance, social network analysis, biometric surveillance, aerial surveillance, data mining and profiling, corporate surveillance, human operatives, satellite imagery, identification and credentials, RFID and geolocation devices (RFID tagging, global positioning system, mobile phones), surveillance through devices (bugs) and surveillance of postal services.

The Free Dictionary enlists three purposes of electronic eavesdropping:

1. Enhancement of security for persons and property
2. Detection and prevention of criminal, wrongful or impermissible activity